Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

1061
-2 -0.23%
Jan 5th, 2024

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

1172
-2.41 -0.21%
Jan 5th, 2024

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

963
0 0.00%
Jan 5th, 2024

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

142.65
0.00 0.00%
Jan 5th, 2024

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

167.50
0.00 0.00%
Jan 5th, 2024

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

1210
25 2.11%
Week Ending Jan 5th, 2024

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2401 (Jan) RMB/t (3pm close)

1000.00
-16.00 -1.57%
Jan 5th, 2024 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
February 24 USD/dmt

138.40
-3.00 -2.12%
Jan 5th, 2024 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2405 (Jan) RMB/t

3979
-67 -1.66%
Jan 5th, 2024 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

29.49
0.07 0.24%
Jan 4th, 2024

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

9.70
-0.38 -3.77%
Jan 4th, 2024

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

4000
20 0.50%
Week Ending Jan 5th, 2024

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

119.31
2.48 2.12%
Week Ending Jan 5th, 2024

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

9.78
0.27 2.87%
Week Ending Jan 5th, 2024

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

4090
20 0.49%
Week Ending Jan 5th, 2024

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Jan 5th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	1061	-2.4	-0.23%	867	887	770	1063	139.85	-0.39	-0.3%	114.77	120.26	100.95	140.24
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	963	0.0	0.00%	771	771	680	963	128.07	-0.06	0.0%	102.74	104.97	89.86	128.13
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	1172	-2.4	-0.21%	984	1020	881	1175	154.98	-0.40	-0.3%	130.67	138.96	116.19	155.37

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Jan 5th, 2024		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	142.65	0.00	0.00%	115.67	115.67	99.20	146.75
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	167.50	0.00	0.00%	129.56	129.56	115.45	168.37

MARKET COMMENTARY

DCE iron ore futures fall by 1.38 in the today. the main contract I2405 closed 1000. Some traders adopt separate quotations. Some steel mills tended to be wait-and-see, and purchased on demand. total transactions remained insipid. PBF at Shandong port dealt 1045-1050 yuan/mt; decreased 10-15 yuan/mt over yesterday. SSF at Tangshan port dealt 940 yuan/mt; decreased 5 yuan/mt over yesterday. As of January 5th, SMM has tracked a total of 119.31 million tons of inventory in 35 ports, with a cumulative inventory of 2.41 million tons compared to last week; The daily average port clearance volume of imported ore in this period increased by 78000 tons on a weekly basis to 2.937 million tons. This week, port clearance continued to increase, but the growth rate slowed down. This is mainly due to the demand for restocking in steel mills near the Spring Festival. However, the current iron ore price is relatively high, and the pace of restocking is slow. Looking ahead next week, pre holiday restocking may drive an increase in transaction volume, while mining prices still have support and are expected to fluctuate at high levels.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Jan 5th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	1210	25	2.1%	983	1036	903	1210	153.57	3.26	2.17%	125.61	136.01	114.47	153.57

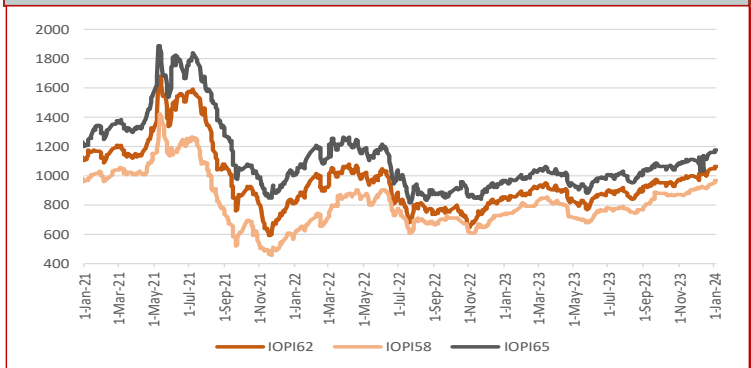
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Jan 5th, 2024				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1211	2.6%	779	1645	170.68	2.64%	110.31	255.69
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1300	3.2%	780	1630	183.23	3.18%	110.51	251.57
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	970	3.2%	620	1310	136.72	3.20%	87.40	202.32
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1277	2.8%	800	1752	179.99	2.83%	0.00	272.32

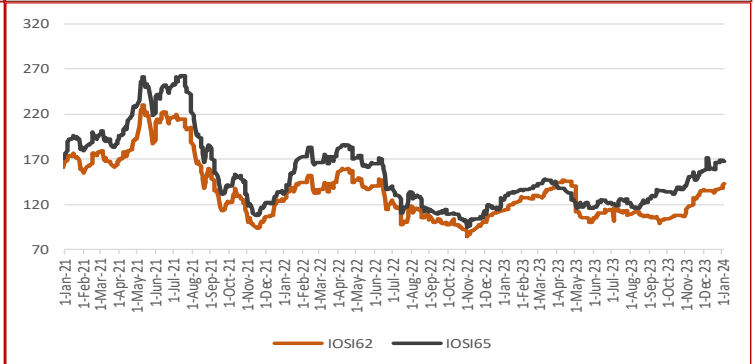
Week Ending Jan 5th, 2024	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	1136.82	2.28%	706.36	1511.22

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 6.7522 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =6.87528

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Jan 5th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	September	October	November	December	MTD	QTD	YTD	September	October	November	December	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	945	947	988	1017	867	862	887	122.79	123.14	129.07	133.85	114.77	114.26	120.26
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	838	869	884	924	771	766	771	109.67	113.94	116.42	122.63	102.74	102.24	104.97
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	1057	1059	1100	1124	984	980	1020	137.74	138.13	144.10	148.34	130.67	130.42	138.96

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Jan 5th, 2024		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	September	October	November	December	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	104.25	106.44	124.61	135.51	112.14	114.50	115.67
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	132.40	135.69	150.46	161.63	122.86	128.12	129.56

FREIGHT RATES

Jan 4th, 2024		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	9.70	-0.38	-3.77%	3.57	16.77
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	29.49	0.07	0.24%	6.70	36.40

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Jan 5th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	September	October	November	December	MTD	QTD	YTD	September	October	November	December	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	1043	1113	1155	1177	933	978	1017	130.25	139.38	145.07	149.11	119.96	125.16	134.98

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Jan 5th, 2024		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-97	-9.17%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	112	10.53%

Jan 5th, 2024		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	24.85	17.42%

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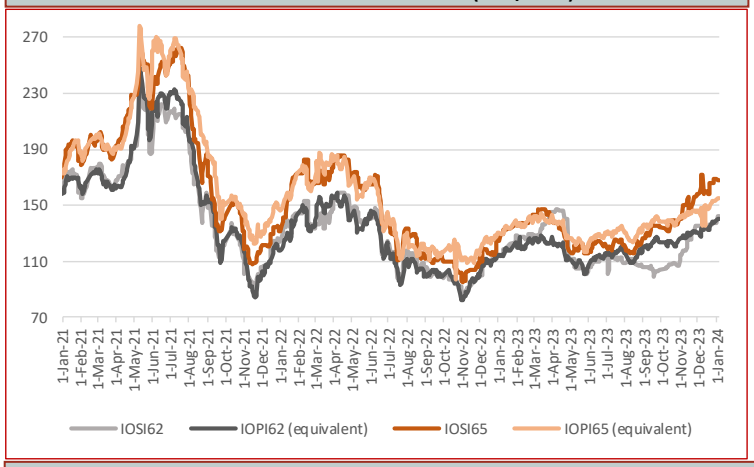
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Jan 5th, 2024	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	1004	-2	-57
SIMEC Fines	937	-2	-124
PB Fines	1026	-2	-35
Newman Fines	1031	-2	-30
MAC Fines	1011	-2	-50
Jimblebar Blended Fines	928	-2	-133
Carajas Fines	1242	-2	181
Brazilian SSF	1029	-2	-32
Brazilian Blend Fines	1040	-2	-21
RTX Fines	945	-2	-116
West Pilbara Fines	971	-2	-90

Jan 5th, 2024	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	138.15	0.00	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	134.65	0.00	-8.00
PB Fines	138.90	0.00	-3.75
Newman Fines	141.80	0.00	-0.85
MAC Fines	138.90	0.00	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	131.28	0.00	-11.38
Carajas Fines	172.20	0.00	29.55
Brazilian SSF	146.40	0.00	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	148.00	0.00	5.35
RTX Fines	132.55	0.00	-10.10
West Pilbara Fines	136.90	0.00	-5.75

Jan 5th, 2024	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	962	-1	-1
FMG Blended Fines	974	-1	11
Robe River	975	-1	12
Western Fines	978	-1	15
Atlas Fines	971	-1	8
Yandi	953	-1	-10

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	25.00	2.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	25.00	5.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	25.00	5.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	25.00	5.00
	Low Grade Fe	12.00	-3.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	20.00	7.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	5.00	-2.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	35.00	-5.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	5.00	-1.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	19.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade	8.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	8.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	8.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	10.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	10.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	10.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	10.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	3.00	0.50
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	1.25	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	2.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	2.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	0.50	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	2.50	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-100.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-20.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-20.00	0.00	Jingtang	-20.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-30.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-40.00	0.00

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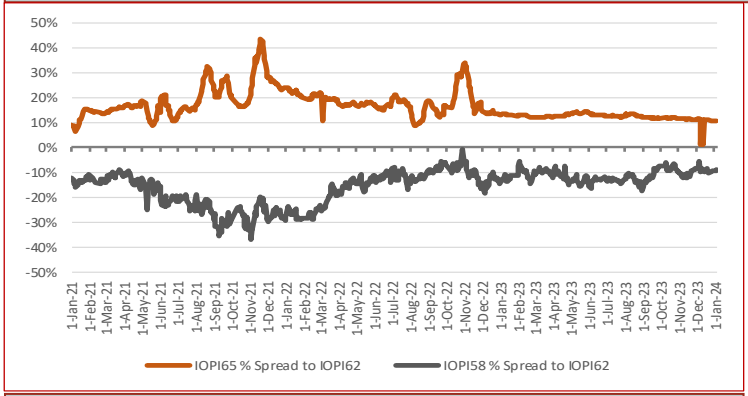
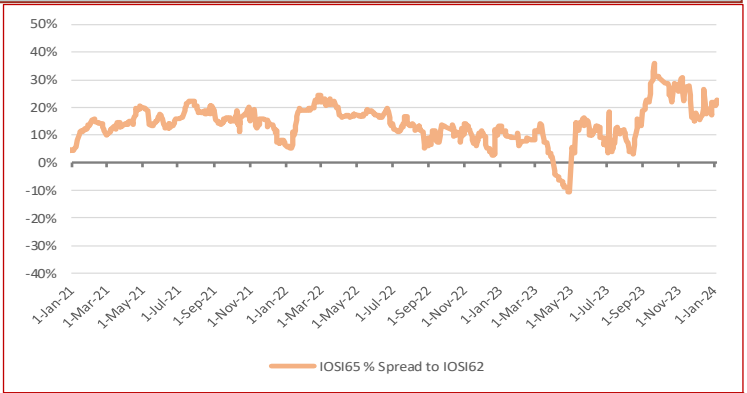
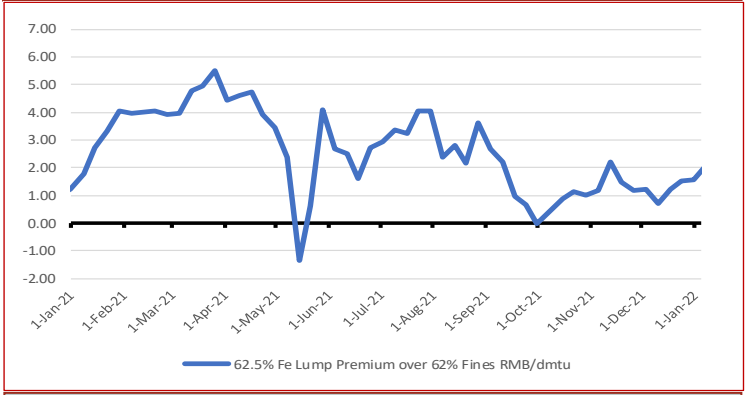
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

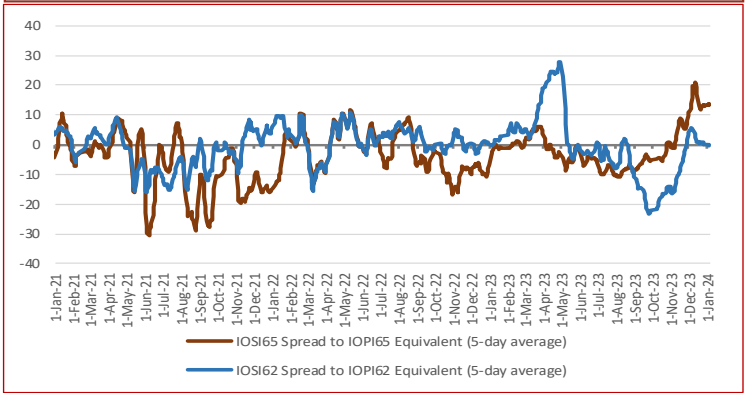




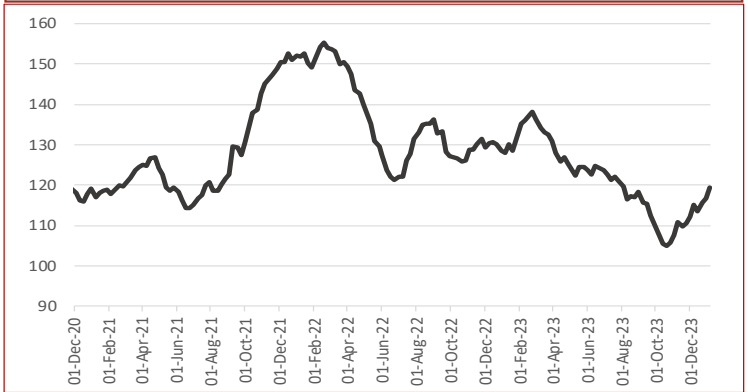
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



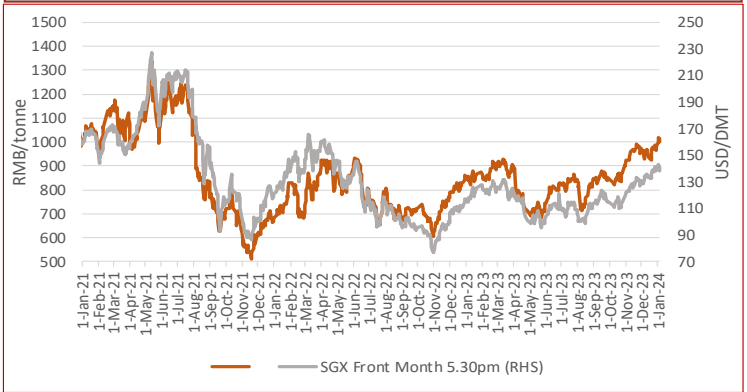
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

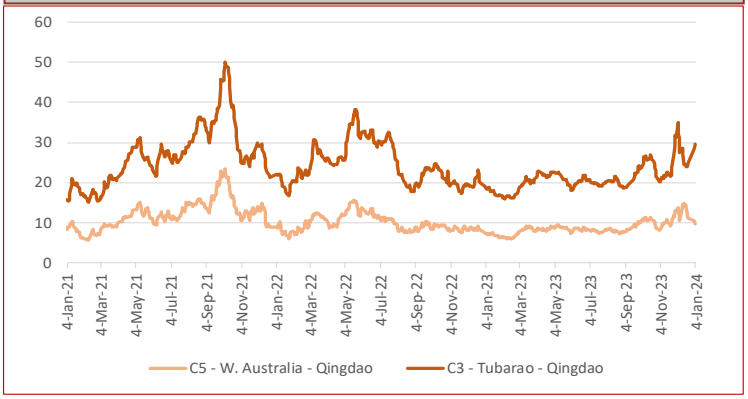
Week Ending Jan 5th, 2024

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	9.74	3.51%	8.41	19.20
Qingdao	23.27	1.31%	9.41	26.24
Caofeidian	11.11	1.00%	7.56	16.29
Tianjin	9.17	-1.08%	6.49	12.97
Rizhao	14.74	-0.20%	9.44	19.26
Total (35 Ports)	119.31	2.12%	98.80	155.39

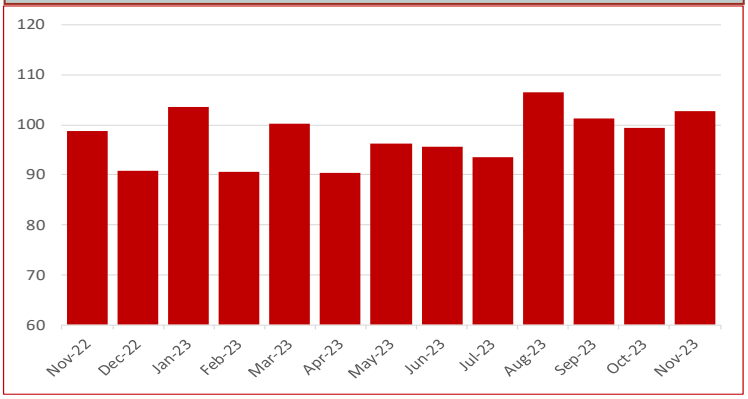
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Jan 5th, 3pm close			Jan 5th, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2405	Change	Change %	Feb. 24	Change	Change %
Closing Price	1000.00	-16.00	-1.57%	138.40	-3.00	-2.12%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	27.30	6.19	29.35%	8.10	1.97	32.14%
Open positions ('000 lots)	55.01	-0.67	-1.20%	39.70	0.43	1.09%
Day Low	993.0	-12.00	-1.19%	137.65	-1.80	-1.29%
Day High	1017.0	-4.50	-0.44%	141.10	-1.55	-1.09%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2024/1/5	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	4,000	20	0.50%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	4,170	10	0.24%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	4,090	20	0.49%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	4,850	0	0.00%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	4,080	20	0.49%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	4,970	0	0.00%
Colour Coated Plate	6,850	-50	-0.72%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

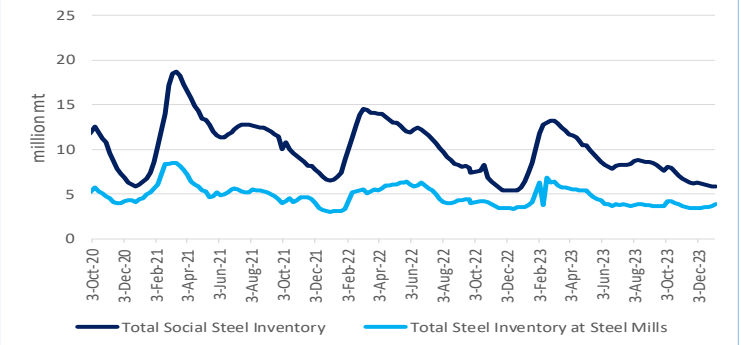
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	142.65	5	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	2,670	-110	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	3,060	50	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	3,478	-10	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	4,157	-11	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	-237	31	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	4,222	-11	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	-172	11	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

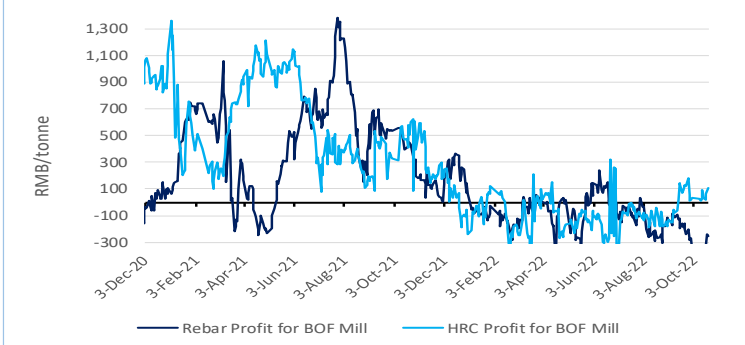
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

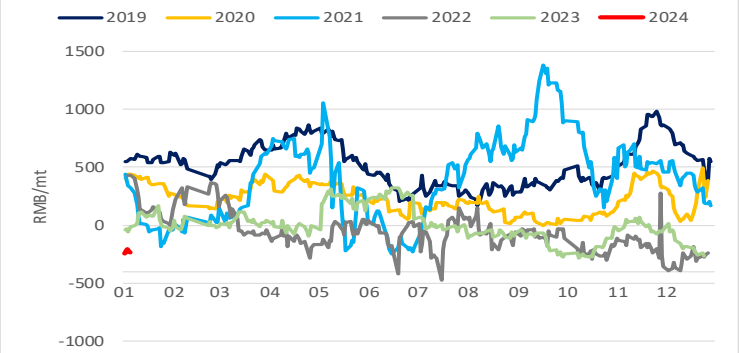
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



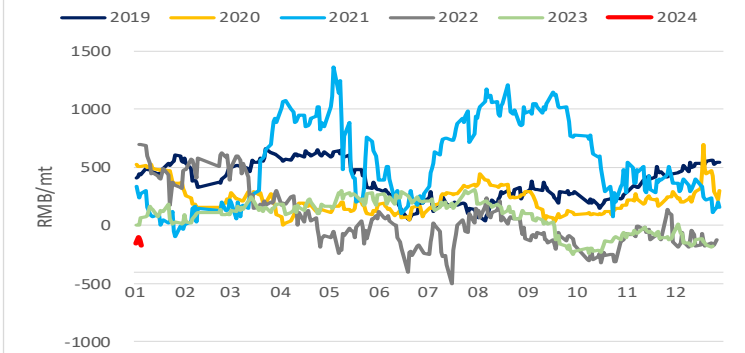
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



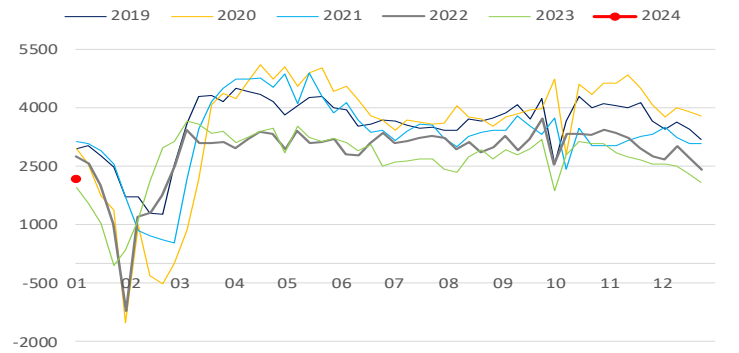
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



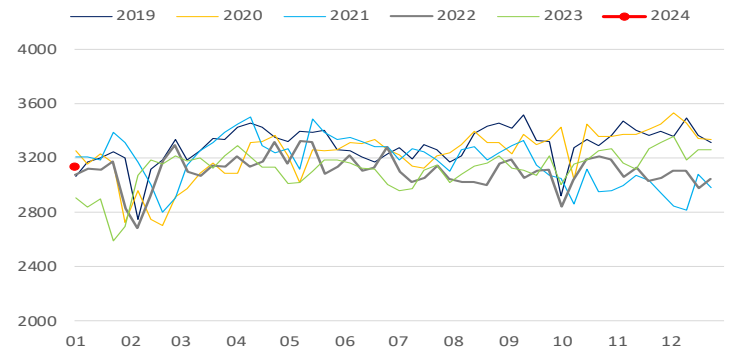
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



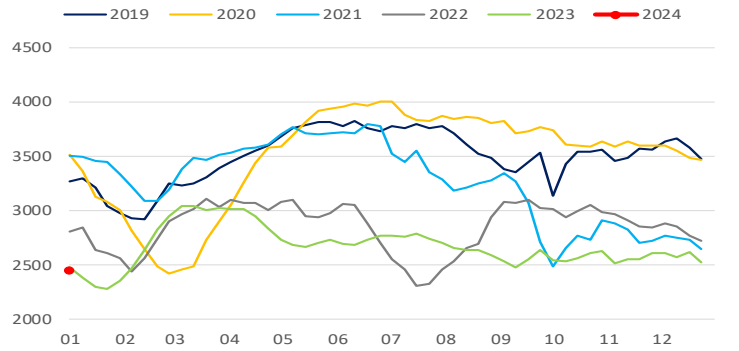
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



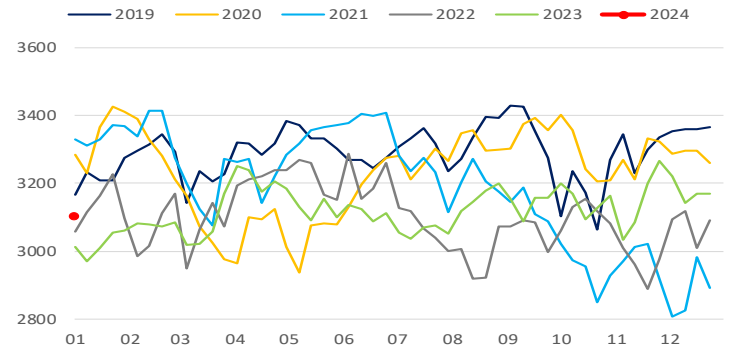
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Jan 5th, 2024	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Jan 5th, 2024	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.30%	0.095%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.40%	0.075%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.10%	4.80%	0.120%	7.80%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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